

24-System: Success & Failure Levels

In the 24-System, you roll dice based on your skill and any situational benefits, then compare your result to a **Difficulty (DC)**.

Your **result** is the sum of your **two highest dice**, plus any flat bonus from skill rank.

Skill Rank Dice Progression

Rank	Roll	Average Result
0	2d12	13
1	d10 + d12 + 2	14
2	2d10 + 4	15
3	d8 + d10 + 6	16
4	2d8 + 8	17
5	d6 + d8 + 10	18
6	2d6 + 12	19

Outcome Levels

Legendary Success (24+) If your final result is **24 or higher**, you achieve an extraordinary, cinematic success.

- You bypass normal limitations
- You gain a powerful additional benefit
- The Guide may allow effects beyond the original intent of the action

Legendary results represent moments where preparation, skill, and circumstance align perfectly.

Partial Critical (Max Die) If **any die** in your roll shows its **maximum value** (e.g., 12 on a d12, 10 on a d10), you gain a **Partial Critical**, even if you do not reach 24.

Partial Criticals grant a flourish or immediate benefit, such as:

- Acting faster
- Avoiding a minor consequence
- Impressing observers
- Gaining positional advantage
- Reducing the impact of Pressure

Partial Criticals reward strong execution even under difficult conditions.

Success If your result **meets or exceeds the DC**, you succeed as intended.
You accomplish your goal cleanly, with no added cost.

~~Hit Location by Outcome (Attacks)~~

~~Unless an ability or called shot says otherwise, attack hit location follows outcome band:~~

- ~~• **Success:** Hit the **Core**.~~
- ~~• **Partial Critical on a hit:** Hit a **limb** (attacker chooses L, R, or Legs).~~
- ~~• **Legendary Success (24+) on a hit:** Hit the **Head**.~~

~~Called shots override this default mapping.~~

Push Your Luck (Optional Reroll)

If you fail a roll, you may choose to **push your luck**.

When you do so:

- You choose one complication track: **Position, Resource, Exposure, Strain, or Objective**.
- You state the fiction for that track (what risk you are taking to force the reroll).
- You must accept a **Minor Complication** on that chosen track.
- You reroll the entire dice pool at **DC -2** (minimum pushed DC 6).
- You must keep the new result.

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This represents forcing the action through stress, danger, or desperation.

Outcomes After Pushing

After the reroll, resolve the outcome normally, with the following escalation rules:

- **Reroll Succeeds (meets or exceeds pushed DC)**
You succeed, and the **Minor Complication** on the chosen track applies.
- **Reroll Succeeds with a Partial Critical**
You gain the Partial Critical benefit, and the **Minor Complication** on the chosen track still applies.
- **Reroll Fails**
You fail the action, and the complication **escalates to a Major Complication on the same track**.

Pushing your luck always carries risk, success comes at a cost, failure compounds.

Critical Failure.

~~Critical Failure~~

~~A **Critical Failure** is optional and should be rare. It represents a collapse beyond a normal Major Complication.~~

~~A Critical Failure occurs when:~~

- ~~• The Guide declares the situation has escalated beyond safe limits, and~~
- ~~• The fiction supports a catastrophic outcome beyond a standard Major Complication.~~

~~On a Critical Failure:~~

- ~~• You fail the action~~
- ~~• You accept a catastrophic consequence (worse than a normal Major)~~
- ~~• The situation escalates immediately and meaningfully~~

~~Critical Failures are not about incompetence, they are about pressure, risk, and consequence.~~

wrong

Miss (No Push)

If your result is below the DC and you **choose not to push**:

- You fail to achieve your goal
- No complication is automatically applied
- The Guide advances the situation naturally

Examples include:

- Time passes
- The environment changes
- Opponents reposition or react
- New information or threats emerge

Failure should move the scene forward, not stall play.

Retry Rule (Especially Outside Combat)

There are no free retries under unchanged fiction.

- A failed roll means this approach does not work in this moment.
- You may retry immediately by using **Push Your Luck** and accepting track consequences.
- You may also attempt again later if the fiction changes meaningfully (different method, different tool, extra help, more time, new leverage, or a new accepted cost).
- If nothing meaningful has changed, the original result stands.

This keeps repeated attempts fiction-first while preserving tension and pace.

Complication Tracks

Complications are always resolved through these five tracks:

- **Position**
- **Resource**
- **Exposure**
- **Strain**
- **Objective**

When you push, these tracks are always available, but the chosen track must be fiction-valid for the action being attempted.

Rule of thumb:

- If a consequence causes a short setback without collapsing agency, it is **Minor**.
- If a consequence changes control of the scene, removes a key option, or forces an immediate new problem, it is **Major**.

Position

What it is: - Where you are, your angle, cover, footing, engagement state, or tactical lane.

Minor qualifies: - Lose cover - End up in a worse approach angle - Give up a favorable lane or stance

Major qualifies: - Get pinned or flanked - Enter a bad range state (forced melee/grapple) - Lose control of space and cede initiative

Does not qualify: - Direct gear damage (use Resource) - Pure alertness/noise consequences (use Exposure)

need more specific.

Resource

What it is: - Consumables, ammo, tools, weapon condition, armor integrity, and other finite assets.

Minor qualifies: - Spend extra ammo/supplies - Tool wear, temporary jam, or reduced reliability - Burn a useful but replaceable item

Major qualifies: - Break key gear - Destroy or lose a critical asset - Permanently degrade an important loadout element in-scene

Does not qualify: - Purely being seen/identified (use Exposure) - Pure movement/angle loss (use Position)

Loss of Integrity

need a kind of guide lines.
like minor cost 1
After major cost a ton

Exposure

What it is: - Being noticed, tracked, identified, or having your intent/location revealed.

Minor qualifies: - Make noise - Leave trace evidence - Raise suspicion or awareness by one step

Major qualifies: - Full detection or identification - Trigger alarm/reinforcements - Reveal ally plan, route, or hiding position

Does not qualify: - Direct fatigue/stamina cost (use Strain) - Gear loss/breakage (use Resource)

Strain

What it is: - Immediate physical or mental load: stamina, pain, shock, panic pressure, instability.

Minor qualifies: - Lose stamina - Brief disorientation - Short-lived fear/panic spike that does not remove agency

Major qualifies: - Heavy stamina loss with immediate tactical penalty - Strong disorientation/panic effect that constrains next action - Short-term functional drop in an anchor-critical moment

Does not qualify: - Narrative clock/progress setbacks (use Objective) - Discovery/alert outcomes (use Exposure)

Objective

What it is: - Progress toward the declared goal: clocks, timing windows, target acquisition, mission state.

Minor qualifies: - Lose momentum - Add delay or extra step - Reduce quality of progress (harder follow-up)

Major qualifies: - Target escapes or relocates - Clock advances to a new threat state - Mission branch closes, forcing a new approach

Does not qualify: - Immediate bodily fatigue cost (use Strain) - Positioning-only consequences (use Position)

Table Safety and Party Harm

Choosing a push consequence that intentionally puts another player character in direct harm is generally not acceptable.

Only allow it when: - The acting player states the risk clearly before rolling, and - The expected benefit clearly and significantly outweighs that harm, and - The table is aligned with that call.

If those conditions are not met, the Guide should require a different complication within the chosen track.

Leverage & Pressure

The 24-System replaces traditional advantage and disadvantage with **Leverage** and **Pressure**.

This system rewards preparation and smart play, while keeping penalties clear and fair.

Leverage

Leverage represents favorable circumstances such as:

- Positioning
- Planning
- Superior tools or gear
- Teamwork
- Surprise or momentum

Each point of Leverage grants a **bonus die**, using the step progression below.

You may gain multiple points of Leverage from different sources.

Leverage Dice Progression

When you have Leverage, add **one bonus die** to your roll:

Leverage	Bonus Die
1	d4
2	d6
3	d8
4	d10
5	d12

Roll all dice together.

Your result is the **sum of your two highest dice**, plus flat bonus.

Leverage dice are never negative.

If circumstances are poor, Pressure applies instead.

Advantage Step Rule

When a rule says an action gains **advantage**, grant exactly **one Leverage step**:

- Start at d4.
- Each additional advantage source increases by one die step (d4 -> d6 -> d8 -> d10 -> d12).
- Roll the acting skill dice and the one leverage die, then keep the two highest dice.
- Advantage effects do not jump multiple steps unless multiple separate sources apply.

*Does same
Happen at
8/12 -> next?
disign advantage.*

Pressure

Pressure represents difficulty, danger, or constraint, such as:

- Darkness, smoke, or noise
- Injury, exhaustion, or fear
- Environmental hazards
- Time pressure
- Opposition or resistance

*May cap at +5
→ Crushing Pressure.*

Pressure **does not affect your dice**.

Instead, Pressure **increases the DC** of the action.

Applying Pressure

Each point of Pressure raises the DC by **+1 to +2**, depending on severity.

Typical examples:

- Low light: +1 DC
- Darkness or smoke: +2 DC
- Wounded or exhausted: +2 DC
- Severe injury or panic: +3 or more DC

The Guide should state the adjusted DC clearly before the roll.

Status Effects

Common status conditions (Blind, Prone, Grabbed, Pinned, Incapacitated, etc.) are defined in **status-effects.md**.

- Status effects may add DC, remove available actions, or constrain RLHF anchors.

- If both Pressure and a status effect apply, use both unless a specific rule says otherwise.
 - If multiple statuses affect the same action, use the most restrictive limit and highest relevant DC increase.
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Key Principles

- Players only roll extra dice when things are going well
- Difficulty comes from harder targets, not worse dice
- Leverage rewards smart play
- Pressure keeps danger real without killing momentum

This system preserves excitement while maintaining tension and fairness.

Optional Rule: Crushing Pressure

In extreme situations, the Guide may declare **Crushing Pressure**.

- You may not gain Leverage on this roll
- The DC is increased significantly

Use this sparingly, for moments of overwhelming danger.

May want All Fails Are
Critical Fails.